

MERIDIAN FORGE / ANALYST DOCUMENT · WEEK 02

Business Case Recommendation

MR-17 QA Review Business Case · Revision 17

QA Control Review · A recommendation for the sponsor

1. Need, value and scope

Proposed project

Conduct a bounded QA review of the MR-17 cell's command-authorization ownership, scheduling and retirement controls, and evidence-preservation process.

Business need

The current process depends on QA requesting records, custodians locating them, and QA and Engineering verifying their origin and meaning. The available records show gaps in source and custodian information that can make records harder to verify. The review is needed to identify these gaps and document the current process without assuming that unverified information is correct.

Expected value and beneficiaries

QA, Engineering, and Operations could benefit from clearer ownership, better documentation of scheduling and retirement controls, and improved preservation of evidence. The review could make future records easier to locate and verify, but no financial savings or other future benefits should be claimed until they are measured.

Included work

Review command-authorization ownership for the affected cell, inventory the controls used to schedule and retire tests, document an evidence-preservation checklist, identify gaps, and prepare a report for later decisions. Deliverables are one command-ownership record, one scheduling/retirement control inventory, and one evidence-preservation checklist. (W02-S03)

Excluded work

The review does not authorize restarting or operating MR-17, changing software or schedules, deleting or modifying original records, purchasing a replacement robot, selecting a vendor, or extending the review to other cells. (W02-S03)

2. Feasibility and limits

Technical feasibility

The review can use the existing documentation tools and read-only record exports. However, access to the required exports has only been requested and has not been confirmed. If access is denied, the work would need to be revised or deferred. (W02-S04)

Operational feasibility

The work can fit around normal duties if the provisional staffing is confirmed. The plan requires 24 analyst hours, 12 engineering hours, 8 QA hours, and 4 Operations hours. Engineering, QA, and Operations availability still needs to be confirmed because their regular duties remain in place. (W02-S04)

Cost and resource feasibility

The base estimate is 48 staff hours at a cost of \$2,820, which is \$180 below the \$3,000 limit. The planning range is \$2,350–\$3,525, so the upper estimate would exceed the limit by \$525. These estimates do not include equipment purchases, software licenses, or overtime. (W02-S05)

Schedule feasibility

The proposed schedule is eight business days, which is within the ten-business-day limit and leaves two days of headroom. The 48 staff hours are total effort across multiple people and are not 48 elapsed hours. The schedule assumes exports arrive by day 3, Engineering can begin on day 4, and tasks can overlap. (W02-S04/W02-S05)

Known constraints

The review has a \$3,000 budget limit and a ten-business-day schedule limit. Access is limited to read-only records and must still be confirmed. Regular staff duties remain in place, and all learner work must remain outside the safety glass. Original records must be preserved and equipment cannot be operated as part of this review. (W02-S04/W02-S05)

Risks and assumptions

The eight-day schedule assumes the required exports arrive by day 3 and staff availability is confirmed. Late exports could delay Engineering, and a QA shift reassignment could remove the planned QA window. These are possible risks, not current delays. Elias/Engineering should confirm export access and the appropriate team leads should confirm staff availability before the work is authorized. (W02-S04)

3. Recommendation and next decision

Success measures and evidence

Success will first be measured by completing all three review deliverables and having Nia and Elias review the source references, unknowns, and preservation steps. Mara should record their feedback for

the sponsor. For later value measurement, keep the measured six-request baseline from W02-S02. A possible future target is having a complete custodian/source link in all six requests in a comparable sample, but the sponsor still needs to approve the target and collection method. No financial savings should be claimed yet.

Recommendation

proceed

Rationale and conditions

I recommend proceeding because the review is limited in scope and the base estimate of \$2,820 is within the \$3,000 budget. The eight-business-day plan also fits within the ten-business-day limit. However, proceeding should depend on confirming access to the required read-only exports and staff availability. The upper cost estimate of \$3,525 is above the budget, so the sponsor should also address that uncertainty before committing. (W02-S04, W02-S05)

Next authorization or information step

The sponsor should confirm authorization only after the required read-only export access and staff availability are confirmed. The sponsor should also decide how to handle the possibility that costs could exceed the \$3,000 limit and approve the target and collection method for measuring later benefits.

Source packet

W02-S01 · Request for a bounded review — Mara Ilyan · Production Operations Manager

W02-S02 · Evidence-retrieval workload — Nia Voss · Night QA Supervisor

W02-S03 · Proposed scope and current workflow — Mara Ilyan with Nia Voss · Review draft

W02-S04 · Capacity, access and operating limits — Elias Chen · Robotics Systems Engineer

W02-S05 · Estimate and success-measure sheet — Mara Ilyan · Planning estimate, not a quote

All case records and figures are fictional teaching data. This report does not authorize spending or operating equipment. The instructor evaluates the reasoning; completed fields are not a grade.